

SCRUM LEADERSHIP SERIES

Product Ownership III: Learning Objectives

Thirteen modules. Each module maps directly to one chapter of Product Ownership III: Leading Agile Organizations. These objectives are used to demonstrate understanding for the Recognized Product Owner 3 credential.

The domain of practice and a Practice Partner are part of the learning.

These objectives are not met by recognizing the language or repeating an accepted explanation. The book and the course must be coupled with the learner's domain of practice, where actual conditions, constraints, and evidence give the objectives meaning.

Every learner works with a Practice Partner: another learner, a practitioner within the learner's domain, or a 3Back Expert Echo. For each significant objective, learners explain it in their own words, connect it to actual work, question one another's accounts, test assumptions and competing explanations, and identify the evidence that would support or challenge their conclusions.

The Practice Partner makes the learner's reasoning visible and correctable. The facilitator provides guidance and calibration, but cannot supply the learner's domain experience or establish professional capability for them. Capability develops through repeated judgment, action, and evidence in the work.

Learning approach: This document applies the learning model described in How 3Back Approaches Learning, 3Back, September 2026.

3back.com/papers/how-3back-approaches-learning

MODULE 01

Scrum and Product Ownership

- 1.1 Evaluate Scrum as behaviors for solving hard problems in a Complex environment.
- 1.2 Use Cynefin to judge when Product Ownership work is Complex or has gone Chaotic.
- 1.3 Distinguish Product Champion, Business Owner, and Team Captain in this book's model.
- 1.4 Explain Product Ownership as everything that sits between Stakeholders and Developers.
- 1.5 Use Scrum's Guardrails to keep Organizational Product work out of self-made Chaos.

MODULE 02

Interacting with Stakeholders

- 2.1 Distinguish Product Stakeholders from other people who only have an opinion.
- 2.2 Evaluate Outcomes and Impacts instead of treating output as the whole result.
- 2.3 Design how Product Ownership will hear Needs and Wants without losing final say.
- 2.4 Keep Stakeholders from directing Developers around the Team Product Owner.
- 2.5 Recommend which Stakeholders belong in Refinement and which do not.

MODULE 03

Backlog Management

- 3.1 Evaluate an Organization's Backlog as several Backlogs owned by different Product Owners.
- 3.2 Distinguish a Business Backlog from a Work Backlog and say who moves Items between them.
- 3.3 Use a sideways view of a Program Backlog to see Capabilities across Teams.
- 3.4 Apply Cost of Delay when a Business Owner must choose what flows next.
- 3.5 Judge whether the Iron Triangle is being held by cutting Quality instead of Scope.
- 3.6 Map who owns each layer of Backlog in the learner's organization.

MODULE 04

Refining the Work Backlog

- 4.1 Evaluate whether the Work Backlog actually contains Ready work for the Teams.
- 4.2 Balance the Production Game and the Improvement Game when ordering work.
- 4.3 Split Stories vertically so each slice can still deliver value.
- 4.4 Separate Acceptance Criteria from Standard of Care on a Story's Definition of Done.
- 4.5 Design a refinement path from Business Backlog Item to Team-Ready Story.

MODULE 05**Business Modeling: The Big Idea**

- 5.1 Express a startup Big Idea on a one-page Lean Canvas from what is known now.
- 5.2 Fill Customer Segments, Problem, and Unique Value Proposition before polishing the rest.
- 5.3 Evaluate whether a Lean Canvas is still a hypothesis or is being treated as a plan.
- 5.4 Use the Lean Canvas to convince Stakeholders the idea has Business Value worth funding.

MODULE 06**Business Modeling: Revenue Projections**

- 6.1 Build a multi-year revenue, cost, and profit projection that Product Ownership can defend.
- 6.2 Evaluate Cost of Delay when a Release slips and costs do not fall with it.
- 6.3 Judge an initial Release as an MVP meant to fund the next development, not as the whole Product.
- 6.4 Analyze how Technical Debt in an initial Release changes later revenue and cost.
- 6.5 Recommend whether more development, maintenance, or debt paydown belongs in the next year.

MODULE 07**Business Modeling: Budgeting for Development**

- 7.1 Size a Release in Passing Acceptance Tests and treat that Size as the stake in the ground.
- 7.2 Evaluate scope creep as more PATs than were budgeted, not as a moral failure.
- 7.3 Decompose a Product into Features and PATs with Stakeholders and SMEs.
- 7.4 Design a development budget that includes work beyond construction.
- 7.5 Use uncertainty ranges, not a single-point estimate, when briefing the Business.

MODULE 08**Business Analysis: Competitive Analysis**

- 8.1 Evaluate competitors with the 4Ps: Product, Price, Place, and Promotion.
- 8.2 Run a SWOT on a competitor without pretending it is a strategy by itself.
- 8.3 Judge where the Organization is weak in the same terms used on the competitor.
- 8.4 Recommend what Product Ownership should change after the competitive read.

MODULE 09**From Idea to Strategy to Product**

- 9.1 Trace work from Idea through Strategy and Vision into Product.
- 9.2 Evaluate a Product Vision as a draft that should change slower than the Backlog.
- 9.3 Design a Story Map that turns strategy into an Initial Backlog and a Release Plan.
- 9.4 Distinguish a Strategic Feature Backlog from a Tactical Work Backlog.
- 9.5 Recommend how Product Ownership facets get instantiated as an Idea becomes a Product.

MODULE 10**Starting a New Scrum Team**

- 10.1 Use Scrum's Circle of Life to show new Teams what Product Ownership must put in place.
- 10.2 Brief people with power on Stakeholder responsibilities before the first Sprint.
- 10.3 Instantiate Product Champion, Business Owner, and Team Captain so the new Team is not owner-optional.
- 10.4 Evaluate whether Guardrails exist before the new Team is asked for forecasts.

MODULE 11**Introduction to Scaling**

- 11.1 Define Scaling as an Organization's response to increasing demand.
- 11.2 Trace how Product Ownership gets complicated as Sam's shop grows.
- 11.3 Judge when adding Developers is the wrong first response.

- 11.4 Evaluate what happens to Product Champions and Business Owners when Teams split.
- 11.5 Recommend whether to scale by growth or by making current Teams more effective.

MODULE 12**Advanced Scaling**

- 12.1 Design a single-layer Pod that produces Results for several Product Champions.
- 12.2 Evaluate the Flow Management Team as the Pod's Product Ownership layer.
- 12.3 Distinguish Production Train, Scrum Master Team, and Scrum-of-Scrums.
- 12.4 Design a Cross-Cutting Workgroup without stripping people from Production Teams.
- 12.5 Recommend when a Pod should grow versus when a new Pod should start.

MODULE 13**Leadership**

- 13.1 Evaluate Product Owners as Team Captains who combine Manager and Director work.
- 13.2 Diagnose how a would-be Perfect Team Captain becomes a Bad Boss.
- 13.3 Select Autocratic, Participative, or Delegative style to match the Organizational decision.
- 13.4 Use Emergent Leadership instead of forcing every lead through the formal Captain.
- 13.5 Design a leadership path that keeps accountability and does not blame the Teams.

3Back delivers Product Ownership III. RPO3 is recognized by the Scrum Guide Organization. These objectives follow Product Ownership III: Leading Agile Organizations by Dan Rawsthorne and Doug Shimp.